



GDD 23 Outbreak

Stop the Spread

Stop it with knowledge, not fear

The STIs-and-HIV game for ages 12-15, a gated, anti-stigma containment sim. Teens stop an outbreak with the real public-health toolkit, education, prevention, vaccines, testing and treatment, and learn that the real enemy is stigma, never the people. Seven mechanics, 18 myth-flips, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Stop it with knowledge, not fear.

Outbreak is the curriculum's game about sexually transmitted infections, including HIV, for ages 12-15. It takes a form teens enjoy, a containment-strategy sim, where you stop an outbreak spreading across a population by deploying the real public-health toolkit: education, prevention, vaccines, testing and treatment. Through play, teens learn how STIs spread (and how they don't), how to prevent them, why testing and treatment are smart and normal, and, at its heart, why stigma is the real enemy. It deepens Defenders of the Body (g20). New v2 build, gated.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g23 · outbreak-stop-the-spread (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · real / matter-of-fact
Thread / topics	F · Sexual & Reproductive Health · UNESCO 8.2, 8.3
Prerequisite / builds on	g22 (Plan It) · builds on g20 (Defenders of the Body)
Gating	Gated (school-comfort toggle)
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the gated STI containment sim.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

18

myth-flips

24

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Gated & anti-stigma. Behind the school-comfort toggle. It is accurate and non-explicit: STIs spread by specific routes (not casual contact), many are silent so testing matters, and **all are treatable and most are curable**. It leads with waiting as fully valid, presents condoms and vaccines factually, and its core message is that **stigma is the real harm**, people with an STI deserve care, never shame. Real questions route to a clinic, doctor or trusted adult.

Five tools beat an outbreak.

The sim's heart: teens deploy the same toolkit public health uses in the real world, and discover that the sixth, quietest tool, cutting stigma, makes all the others work.

Education

Prevention (wait / condoms)

Vaccines (HPV)

Testing

Treatment

End stigma

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES IN THE SIM
Education	People who know the facts protect themselves, the first line.
Prevention	Not having sex (fully reliable, respected) and condoms (reduce STI + pregnancy risk).
Vaccines	The HPV vaccine prevents ~70% of cervical cancers, free for 14-year-old girls in India.
Testing	Finds the silent, symptomless cases that waiting would miss.
Treatment	Treats cases, which heals the person and breaks the chain of spread.
End stigma	Cuts the shame that stops people testing and treating, so people seek care.

Facts that contain fear.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Riya, 15	Calm facts (and the HPV vaccine) over scary rumours.	strike-rewrite + build : bust myths; vaccine facts.
Veer, 14	To know STIs aren't about being a 'type' of person.	strike-rewrite : anyone, not 'certain people'.
The Counsellor	To make testing feel normal, smart and confidential.	branch + role-play : test & treat.
Every teen	To react to an STI with facts and kindness, not fear.	branch + reflect : end the stigma.

Why this works (the evidence). STIs spread through sexual contact, blood and parent-to-baby, not casual contact; many (like chlamydia and gonorrhoea) are "silent" with no symptoms, so testing is the only way to know. All STIs, even HIV, are treatable and most are curable; prevention works, waiting (fully reliable), condoms (reduce risk), and vaccines (the HPV vaccine prevents ~70% of cervical cancers and is free for 14-year-old girls in India), plus testing and treating. Stigma is the real harm: it stops people seeking care, so cutting it is itself a public-health tool.

Seven moves, led by strategy.

It's a containment sim, so **branch** (deploy-the-toolkit decisions) and **strike-rewrite** (bust the myths and stigma) co-lead, with **sort** doing the public-health triage. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (containment) <i>signature</i>	Deploys a public-health tool and sees the outbreak respond.	Strategy; consequence.	18
strike-rewrite (myth-flip) <i>signature</i>	Flips an STI myth or stigma ("you'd know" → many are silent).	Conceptual change.	18
sort	Sorts spreads vs doesn't; reliable vs not; reduces vs spreads stigma.	Public-health triage.	16
reflect	Considers fear vs facts, judgement vs compassion.	Anti-stigma; empathy.	14
match	Pairs a route to its prevention; a myth to the fact that beats it.	Cause & fix.	7
role-play (voice)	Asks about testing; defends someone; tells a partner.	Help-seeking; allyship.	6
build	Builds the toolkit, the prevention ladder, the test-and-treat chain.	The system, by hand.	5

18 myths flipped, 24 branch/role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the spread → silent → contain → test/treat → myths → stigma arc, verified and anti-stigma. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
How STIs spread (and don't)	14	sort, strike-rewrite, match	Sexual contact, blood, parent-baby; not casual contact.
The silent part	12	strike-rewrite, sort, match	Many are symptomless; can't tell by looks; why testing matters.
Stop the spread (toolkit)	16	branch, build, sort	The containment sim: wait, condoms, HPV vaccine, test, treat.
Testing & treatment	14	branch, role-play, build	Smart, normal, confidential; treatable, most curable; partners.
Bust the STI myths	14	strike-rewrite, sort, match	"You'd know", "only certain people", toilet seats, "one time".
End the stigma	14	branch, role-play, reflect	Stigma is the enemy; no shame; support, privacy, care.

A containment branch + a silent-part flip, verbatim.

branch: "Outbreak sim: cases are silent and hidden. Which tool finds them?"
 best -> "Testing, it reveals what symptoms hide" (hidden cases surface and get treated)

flip: "You'd always know if you had an STI."
 UN -> "You'd definitely know if you had an STI."
 RE -> "Many STIs have no symptoms at all, the only way to know is testing."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 23 Outbreak Stop the Spread — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	FACT (RE WRITES)	BASIS
You can catch an STI from a toilet seat.	STIs don't spread from toilet seats or surfaces.	CDC.
You'd always know if you had an STI.	Many are silent; the only way to know is testing.	Asymptomatic.
You can tell who has an STI by looking.	You cannot; many people don't know themselves.	Asymptomatic.
Only 'certain kinds' of people get STIs.	Anyone sexually active can; they don't discriminate.	Anti-stigma.
Doing it once can't give you an STI.	One instance of unprotected contact can transmit one.	Transmission.
An STI means you're dirty or bad.	An STI is a common health condition, nothing to do with worth.	Anti-stigma.
STIs are an incurable doom.	All are treatable and most are curable.	Treatment.
Stigma is harmless, just words.	Stigma stops people testing and treating, so it spreads disease.	Public health.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "an outbreak's spreading, what do you deploy first?".
2. **Play.** Deploy a tool (branch), flip a myth, sort fact from stigma, rotated.
3. **The outbreak responds.** Good tools visibly slow the spread; the debrief names why.
4. **The flip.** On a myth, UN strikes it and RE writes the verified fact ("toilet seats" → never).
5. **End the stigma.** The plan only works once shame is cut, so people test and treat.
6. **Sticker.** The Containment badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **containment map** (deploy tools, watch the spread respond) plus the **myth-flip card**. The myth-flip and anti-stigma engine is shared with Defenders of the Body (g20); the testing/help routing links to the clinic-finder used across SRH.

Accurate, calm, anti-stigma.

- **Gated.** Behind the school-comfort toggle; respects family and school readiness.
- **Accurate & non-explicit.** Transmission is named by route, not graphic detail; the focus is health and prevention.
- **Waiting leads, options follow.** Not having sex is fully reliable and respected; condoms and vaccines are presented factually.
- **Stigma is the enemy.** The game never shames; it frames STIs as common, treatable health conditions and defends the people who have them.
- **Testing normalised.** Testing is smart, routine and often confidential; treatment works; tell-partners is responsible, not blame.
- **Route to care.** Clinics, doctors, youth-friendly services and trusted adults are the sources; rumours and porn are flagged.
- **Access.** Audio-first, private, offline; India-grounded (HPV vaccine); pairs with Defenders of the Body (g20) and Plan It (g22).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. outbreak-stop-the-spread** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; **branch** drives the containment sim, **strike-rewrite** the myth/stigma flips.
- **Gating.** gating = "Gated"; the engine must honour the toggle.
- **Fact-checked content.** STI transmission, asymptomatic and treatable/curable facts (CDC) and the HPV-vaccine India rollout verified; flag medical edits for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 21%, 0% binary, 24 autonomy, 18 UN→RE, 4 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Tracked.** sync_master_tracker.py marks g23 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.
- **Generated path.** Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Safety contracts (never traded for engagement): gated; accurate and non-explicit; waiting leads; stigma is the enemy; testing normalised and confidential; route to real care; medically verified; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Stigma, not the infection, is the spreader.** Because shame stops people testing and treating, the most powerful containment move is reducing stigma, so the game makes "end the stigma" an explicit tool and its emotional core.
- **Silent infections make testing essential.** Since many STIs have no symptoms, "you'd know" is false and dangerous, so the game normalises testing as the only reliable way to know, smart, routine and confidential.
- **Prevention is real and layered.** Waiting, condoms, vaccines (HPV, now free for 14-year-old girls in India), testing and treatment each cut the spread, so the sim rewards deploying them together, with accurate, India-relevant facts.

Sources: CDC STI facts (transmission, asymptomatic "silent" infections, all treatable and most curable, testing); Gavi / India MoHFW nationwide HPV vaccination rollout (free for 14-year-old girls; prevents ~70% of cervical cancers). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 27 games now v2. Next in Chapter 4: Green Light / Red Light (g24, consent).